

Poetry Study





About the Course

This course helps students explore and enjoy poems on many levels; lessons include practice in both reading and writing about poetry.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11	Poetry Study: Grade 11 2 times/week 15 min	The Word Made Fresh Poetry Anthology

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 11

☐ You'll need a journal and a poetry anthology or two of your choice for this course, as well as the assigned book. A few suggested anthologies are listed in Extra Helpings.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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The Word Made Fresh



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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Poetry Study: Grade 11

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

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Term 1

WEEK 1

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-89 "in the introduction" - "dynamic surprise."

- What do you think about the idea of poetry as friendship?
- Throughout this course, keep a personal anthology of poems that you've read and liked in your journal. Van Engen starts his book by encouraging us to browse an anthology until we come across a poem that we resonate with in some way, and then to start noticing what poems we like, expanding our circle of friends.

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are jumping into this course, feel free to read the previous chapters on your own time. However, several sections in the upcoming chapter review some of the previous concepts, so it is perfectly fine to start here!

WEEK 1

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 2

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

Journal about this quote and reflection questions from p.263, "Ch.4, Think of Poetry Like Friendship, #1":

"If we think of approaching a poem like we might approach a friend, it changes the way we read it. We will pass over many people, many poems, until we find something we share. And very often that shared ground will nourish some form of pleasure or delight. But a good friend, in the end, always brings more than we bargained for. The more we spend time together and the more we converse, the more layers our conversations reveals (88)."

- Have you experienced a good friendship? Are you open to being surprised, nourished, challenged, and confronted? When has that happened? What does that look like? Have you experienced any sort of book or poem as a good friend before?

WEEK 2

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-91 "With that in mind" - "at once."

- Can you think of a time when you learned something unexpectedly from a friend?

WEEK 2

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 4

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Use your anthology of choice and read some poetry today. Look for a poem that might become a new friend! Start your personal anthology of poems you like in your journal.

WEEK 3

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-93 "To illustrate" - "it yields."

- Van Engen writes, "Poetry dwells, quite often, in pictures and particulars." Give examples of where you have seen this to be true in poems you have read.

WEEK 3

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 6

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Read more poems today. Read a poem that catches your attention at least twice and at least once out loud. What "particulars" does it contain?

WEEK 4

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-95 "The second image" - "by the dark."

- Have you ever reread a children's book or a poem that you hadn't read for years? Did you have the experience the author describes of meeting an old friend in a fresh way?

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Term 1

WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 8 Materials: Anthology & Journal → REFLECT Read more poems and add to your personal anthology. What questions can you think of to ask your new friends?	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 9 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.95-98 "How do poems" - "misfortunes of life." Have you ever seen something out of the side of your eye that disappears when you look directly at it? Sometimes you can see faint stars with your peripheral vision that disappear when you look right at them. This is another way to think about poetry. Poems often tell us things through associations.	• EXTRA HELPINGS ∞ Tell the truth but tell it slant by Emily Dickinson
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 10 Materials: Anthology & Journal → REFLECT Read some more poems today. When you find one that makes you want to ask more, journal about all the associations it brings to mind.	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 11 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.98-99 "Let me illustrate" - "with them." Reread "Those Winter Sundays", and start considering it with the questions Van Engen brings up from the last chapter.	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 12 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Reread "Those Winter Sundays" on p. 98-99, then answer the four main questions on p.99 (orally or in writing).	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 13 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.99-101 "But for the purposes" - "its sounds." Have you ever thought about sound in poetry beyond whether it rhymes at the end of a line?	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 14 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS • Pick a poem you like and think about questions #5-7 on p.100. Not all poems use sound in the same way, but do you notice anything about your poem's sounds?	
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 15 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.101-102 "That story" - "reader as well." Discuss the sentence: "Poets write themselves into recognition."	

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Term 1

WEEK 8

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 16

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ CREATE

- Make a bookmark or infographic with Questions #1-7 on it to keep with you as you read more poetry.

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-105 "More largely" - "friendship expands."

- What experiences does "Those Winter Sundays" make you think of? Our imaginations are funny things. Have you ever thought about the fact that if someone says, "imagine a chair," to a group of people, everyone will imagine a chair? But if you ask them to describe what they are imagining, they will all describe different chairs. One person's chair is a rocking chair, another's is a bar stool, and another's is a lounge chair in a living room. Poems evoke certain connotations but bring up different resonances within each of us, depending on our experiences. And even similar experiences are still not identical for each of us.

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 18

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

- Discuss the last sentences of Ch.3. Have you seen poetry illuminate your own experience or the experience of others? In the last chapter, the author talked about how poems are meant to be shared and discussed. Read some more poems and share a poem with someone this week!

WEEK 10

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 19

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Read another poem and journal your thoughts on it using the 4 questions.

WEEK 10

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 20

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Reread the poem from the last lesson and reflect on questions 5-7 on p.100.

WEEK 11

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 21

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, anthology, and/or journal

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Use this lesson to catch up on lessons in this or another course. Or just spend some time reading poetry and noting down any more poems you like in your anthology.

WEEK 11

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 22

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, anthology, and/or journal

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Use this lesson to catch up on lessons in this or another course. Or just spend some time reading poetry and noting down any more poems you like in your anthology.

WEEK 12

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

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Term 1

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Term 2

WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 25 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → INTRO How many poetic forms do you know? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.106-109 "In chapter 3" - "make a poem." • What poetic forms can you think of that exist just in the Bible?	• EXTRA HELPINGS Read Ch.3
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 26 Materials: Anthology → REFLECT Read some poems this week and notice all you can about their form.	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 27 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.109-110 "Two things happen" - "which to sing." • Do you think there are still poetic forms yet to be invented?	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 28 Materials: Bible & Journal → READ & REFLECT Can you think of poets who have broken with tradition to invent a new form? Jot any down. Then spend some time reading more psalms today.	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 29 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.110-113 "Questions" - "in control" • Can you think of any poems that turn a common phrase or verse slightly on its head?	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 30 Materials: Journal & Audio → LISTEN & REFLECT Begin listening to Van Engen and two others talk about Countee Cullen's poem that you read on p.111. ∞ Audio Link: Countee Cullen (listen to about half the podcast)	★ TEACHER/STUDENT NOTE This podcast talks about Countee Cullen's life and struggles to understand God. There is also a mention of the fact that he was likely gay.
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 31 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.113-114 "What reasons" - "at his command." • Note how the discussion today about form ties back to the last chapter on poetry as friendship. As you make more friends with poems, old and new, it will be easier to recognize when a poet is using an older form or making an allusion to an older poem.	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 32 Materials: Journal & Audio → LISTEN & REFLECT Finish listening to Van Engen and two others talk about Countee Cullen's poem that you read on p.111. ∞ Audio Link: Countee Cullen (listen to about half the podcast)	

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Term 2

WEEK 5

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.114-116 "Knowing that" - "with form."

- Can you think of people who have done the same thing that Countee Cullen did with poetry in another field, such as art, music, food, or handicrafts?

WEEK 5

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 34

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Look up more of Countee Cullen's poems today if you enjoyed the one we've learned about. Or go looking for more poem-friends in your anthology. Notice the formal features of a poem you read and like.

WEEK 6

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ INTRO

Have you read anything by Langston Hughes before?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.116-119 "Today, most people" - "sing new songs."

- Discuss the last sentences of the section we read today.

WEEK 6

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 36

Materials: Journal & Audio

→ LISTEN & REFLECT

Explore more about Langston Hughes and the poem from this section of the chapter. Begin listening to the podcast and finish on your own time if interested.

∞ Audio Link: Langston Hughes

- Compare Hughes' poem with the one by Countee Cullen on pg.111.

WEEK 7

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 37

Materials: The Word Made Fresh & anthology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.119-122 "One might think" - "always there."

- Look up and read some golden shovel poems.

WEEK 7

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 38

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ & REFLECT

Reread Gwendolyn Brooks' poem from the chapter and then read and reflect on Harjo's "American Sunrise". What do you notice about how these poems are related?

∞ Poem Link: "American Sunrise"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Audio Link: American Sunrise Podcast

WEEK 8

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 39

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.122 -124 "In the rest" - "successive lines."

→ READ

"Christmas Tree" poem by James Merrill

∞ Poem Link: "Christmas Tree" poem

WEEK 8

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 40

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Look up and enjoy more poems by George Herbert. Reflect on them using the model that Van

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Term 2

Engen has given you.

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 41

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.124-127 "If some poems" - "that results."

- Discuss the idea that "knowledge increases pleasure." Where have you seen this to be true in your life?

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 42

Materials: Anthology, The Word Made Fresh, Journal

→ REFLECT

Read more poems and/or look back at poems you like and reflect on the ways form is at work in them.

WEEK 10

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 43

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-132 "Other forms" - "invent his own."

WEEK 10

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 44

Materials: Anthology, Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Read more poetry and reflect on the ways form is at work. You may want to look up more information on the poet and the poem's form since so many discussions on form rely on understanding its context.

WEEK 11

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.132-135 "When considering" - "as depths."

WEEK 11

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 46

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ & REFLECT

Van Engen writes, "Look for the sentences, find the periods. Contrast the grammar a poet uses with the stanza breaks and formal choices."

- Pick a poem to review or a new one you find in your anthology and follow Van Engen's instructions above.

WEEK 12

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Term 3

WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 49 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.136-137 "If you want" - "links them?" Spend some time thinking about the author's questions yourself.	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 50 Materials: The Word Made Fresh & Journal → REFLECT Write your thoughts on Bradstreet's poem. Why are the two stanzas put together? What links them?	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 51 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.137-139 "Whenever two" - "you notice?" STOP before reading the author's thoughts and answer his question--What do you notice about the nouns now that most of the poem has been erased?	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 52 Materials: Anthology & Journal → READ & REFLECT Look back at a poem that has caught your attention or find a new poem in your anthology and practice erasure. You may want to look up the poem online and copy it into a document where you can manipulate the text more easily.	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 53 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.139-140 "Many of them" - "words are they?" Now give your thoughts on the verbs!	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 54 Materials: Anthology & Journal → READ & REFLECT Using the same poem you started working on two lessons ago OR a new poem, practice focusing on just the verbs.	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 55 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.140-141 "Notice the suffering" - "adjectives and adverbs." Look at the poem's isolated adjectives and adverbs on p.141-142. How does this add meaning and focus?	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 56 Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Journal, Anthology → READ & REFLECT Pick a poem (the same one from the last two weeks or a new one) and concentrate on the adjectives and adverbs.	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 57 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.142-143 "The adjectives and adverbs" - "nature_fate."	EXTRA HELPINGS ∞ Audio Link: Anne Bradstreet Podcast

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Term 3

- What do you notice about the repetitions now?

WEEK 5

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 58

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Pick a new poem and choose a few things to focus on to see what you can notice: nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, repetition, etc.

WEEK 6

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 59

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.143-146 "Elegies like this" - "a time."

- Look back at the sonnet (p.144-145) and find where the sentences start and stop. Look at the first one and discuss everything you notice.

WEEK 6

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 60

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Choose a poem you already like or find a new one and notice the punctuation and sentences.

WEEK 7

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 61

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.147- 150 "Batter my heart" - "ravish."

- What did you think of all the different images in the poem? Discuss what you see by isolating the verbs.

WEEK 7

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 62

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Pick a new poem to reflect on and focus on the imagery in the poem. Erase anything else you think might be interesting to notice further.

WEEK 8

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 63

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.150-153 "As you glance" - "admit him."

WEEK 8

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 64

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Read some new poems in your anthology today and find a new one that connects with you.

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 65

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-154 "Erasure, as we" - "Christian care?"

WEEK 9

15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 66

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

"Look to the verbs. Isolate the nouns. Examine the adjectives. Erase for sentences. Pull out all repetitions or requests. Scrub away the poem according to the actions of each person or object." (p.153)

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Term 3

- Use erasure to consider another poem of your choice. You'll continue your reflections over the next two lessons.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 67

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Continue your work with the poem from the last lesson.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Continue your work with the poem from Lessons 66-67. How many different things have you discovered? Some poems will yield more insight from erasure than others, so you haven't done anything wrong if you don't come up with astonishing insights from these exercises. But all of them will help you understand the poem more deeply and train your attention.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 69

Materials: The Word Made Fresh and/or anthology

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Catch up on lessons, read more poetry, or peek at the rest of the book!

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 70

Materials: The Word Made Fresh and/or anthology

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Catch up on lessons, read more poetry, or peek at the rest of the book!

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Examination

- Term 1** · The Word Made Fresh: How are poetry and friendship related? Tell about a poem that has become a friend this term or a poem that has been a friend for a long time.
- Term 2** · The Word Made Fresh: Tell about a poem you've read this term and the importance of form.
- Term 3** · The Word Made Fresh: Talk about erasure - how to go about it and what it can reveal about a poem. Give an example from the term.